

Climate Resilience through Community-Led Adaptive Agriculture

Fellowship Applicant

Dr. Elena Vasquez

Senior Research Fellow, Agro-Ecological Systems

Vertex Research Institute, Nimbus University

Request

\$ 185,000

Over 24 Months



Submission

15 September 2026



Duration

January 2027 – December
2028



Region

San Martín Valley, Peru



Beneficiaries

1,200+ Households

Executive Summary

The Meridian Philanthropic Foundation is respectfully requested to consider a fellowship grant of **\$185,000** over twenty-four months to support Dr. Elena Vasquez in implementing a community-led adaptive agriculture programme in the San Martín Valley of northern Peru. This region, home to approximately 1,200 smallholder farming households, faces accelerating threats from climate variability: shifting rainfall patterns, prolonged dry spells, and increased pest pressure have reduced maize and coffee yields by an average of 34% over the past six years.

The proposed fellowship enables Dr. Vasquez to transfer her research into practice through three integrated workstreams: (1) establishing six demonstration farms showcasing drought-tolerant varieties and water-harvesting techniques; (2) training thirty community extension agents; and (3) co-designing a participatory climate-monitoring network that delivers localised forecasts to farming households via a mobile platform developed with the Synapse Institute for Rural Technology.

This initiative aligns with the Foundation's strategic priority of *Building Climate-Resilient Livelihoods* and extends the promising results of Dr. Vasquez's pilot trial (2024–2025), which achieved a 28% yield improve-